British Applied College
الكلية التطبيقية البريطانية

Navigating the Digital Frontier

Consumer Rights & Accessibility

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Imagine This...

Have you ever felt like your phone is listening to you?

Or tried to use an app that just wouldn't work for you?

Quick Poll

- [ ] I read every single word.
- [ ] I skim the highlights.
- [ ] "Accept All" is my best friend.

What’s the Game Plan?

Identify

Key global consumer protection laws like the FTC and GDPR.

Understand

The impact of accessibility legislation like the ADA and WCAG.

Analyze

The consequences of non-compliance for modern organizations.

Apply

These concepts to real-world digital scenarios and challenges.

The Shield: Consumer Protection Laws

FTC Act (USA)

The primary legislation prohibiting **unfair or deceptive practices** in commerce. It establishes the FTC to enforce consumer protection.

FCRA

The **Fair Credit Reporting Act** p
specific guidelines for the coll
use of consumer data in the c
industry.

TILA

The **Truth in Lending Act** ensures transparency in the financial industry, protecting consumers from predatory lending practices.

The Gold Standard: GDPR & Global Rights

GDPR Key Rights

- **Right to Access**
  See what data a company has on you.
- **Right to be Forgotten**
  Request the deletion of your personal data.
- **Explicit Consent**
  Organizations must obtain consent before processing data.

India

Consumer Protection Act (CPA)

China

Consumer Protection Law (CPL)

Compliance

Failure leads to massive fines and loss of trust.

Activity: "Your Data, Your Choice"

Scenario: You find out a fitness app is selling your heart rate data to insurance companies without your clear consent.

Which law (FTC or GDPR) would you use to challenge this, and what specific right would you claim?

Breaking Barriers: Digital Accessibility

Equal Access

Ensuring people with disabilities have equal access to information and technology, including websites and apps.

The ADA (USA)

Prohibits discrimination in all areas of public life, including digital products and services.

Accommodations

Organizations must make reasonable accommodations to ensure their digital offerings are usable for everyone.

Global Standards: WCAG & Beyond

WCAG

The **Web Content Accessibility Guidelines** are the international standard for making web content more accessible.

EU Directive

Requires public sector websites and mobile applications to be accessible in accordance with **WCAG**.

Global Reach

Laws like the **AODA** (Canada) and **DDA** (Australia) ensure equal access to digital products and services.

Case Study: The Cost of Ignoring Rights

Domino's Pizza Lawsuit

The Issue

A blind man sued Domino's because their website wasn't compatible with screen-reading software.

The Result

The US Supreme Court allowed the lawsuit to proceed, signaling that the ADA applies to websites.

Key Lesson

Accessibility is a **legal requirement**, not an optional feature for digital products.

Impact

Digital spaces are considered **public spaces** under the law.

Activity: The Accessibility Audit

The 60-Second Challenge: Open your favorite app. Can you navigate it using **only one hand**? If you closed your eyes, would the screen reader make sense?

What's one thing that would make this app more accessible?

Why Compliance Matters (Or Else!)

Massive Fines

GDPR violations can cost up to **€20 million** or 4% of global annual turnover, whichever is higher.

Legal Action

Lawsuits can tie up organizations for years, leading to **significant legal costs** and operational disruptions.

Reputation

Loss of **consumer trust** is harder to fix than a fine. A bad reputation can lead to long-term business failure.

Wrapping Up: Your Digital Future

- **Consumer Laws** (FTC, GDPR) are your digital armor.
- **Accessibility** (ADA, WCAG) is about equal opportunity.
- **Compliance** builds trust and avoids legal disasters.

"As future developers or business leaders, how will you prioritize user rights in your next project?"

Thank You! Any Questions?